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Sotheby: Hooray! Ms. Vertin's decoration plan is finally complete! Ms. Regulus is throwing a day-and-night-long party. She's already going door to door to hand out invitations!

Lilya: I wouldn't say forcing people counts as an "invitation." Anyway, she can do what she wants.

Lilya: Hey, did the boss set up all these fancy decorations herself?

Sotheby: Yes, everyone came together! See this palm? It was planted by Ms. Druvis herself!

Sotheby: Hm? Yesterday it could barely reach my head, and now it's almost touching the ceiling!

Lilya: No wonder this place feels like a garden now.

Sotheby: A garden? Oh, I love gardens! The honey-dripping flowers, the rainbow-colored birds—just like in the book Ms. Vertin gave me.

Lilya: Which book? Wait—are you talking about that one you've been carrying around these days?

She taps her finger on the wooden table, snapping Sotheby out of her daydreams.

A heavy picture book sits open on the corner of the table, with a bookmark neatly placed between the pages.

Lilya: "Rather than being exotic, towns in tropical regions are more a revival of past scenery."

Sotheby: Hm? Oh, Ms. Vertin read me that passage. It's a book of stories from South America.

Lilya: South America? Why do I keep hearing those words lately?

Lilya: I heard it's always hot and humid there—completely different from Siberia ... but their rum is pretty good.

Sotheby: When I wasn't even tall enough to reach the table, Mr. Karson would tell me all kinds of stories about the "Mystical Continent"—floating stone steps, fields of golden herbs, and the Fountain of Youth ...

Sotheby: He said that once I grew up, I could go there and have an adventure!

Sotheby: Ms. Lilya, do you think I could go on that adventure now?

Lilya: Don't ask me. That's a question for the heavens. But who knows? Maybe you can come along for a ride on the Amazon River.

Lilya: The Zeno telegram said that the old admiral's been transferred to that area.

Sotheby: Wow! Really?!

Sotheby's fantastic imaginings of the tropics are interrupted as the owner of the suitcase returns, giving an apologetic bow.

Vertin: Sorry to interrupt you; I'll leave as soon as I'm done.

Vertin: The Foundation has assigned us a new task. We'll be heading out to São Paulo soon.